

Wētā FX Presents Avatar: The Way of Water

Eric Saindon
eric@wetafx.co.nz
Wētā FX
Wellington, New Zealand

Sarah Fitton
sfitton@wetafx.co.nz
Wētā FX
Wellington, New Zealand

Joe Letteri
letteri@wetafx.co.nz
Wētā FX
Wellington, New Zealand

Richard Baneham
rbaneham@avtr.com
Lightstorm Entertainment
Wellington, New Zealand

Nicholas Illingworth
nillingworth@wetafx.co.nz
Wētā FX
Wellington, New Zealand

Marco Revelant
mrevelant@wetafx.co.nz
Wētā FX
Wellington, New Zealand



ABSTRACT

Wētā FX's Senior VFX Supervisors Joe Letteri and Eric Saindon, Pre-Production Supervisor Marco Revelant, FX Supervisor Nick Illingworth will be joined by Lightstorm Entertainment's VFX Supervisor Richard Baneham to discuss the VFX for this award-winning film.

With 2,225 water shots, the journey began with over five years of R&D. The talk will cover the creation of the new technology as well as the scope of innovation undertaken throughout the pipeline and why it was essential to deliver the film. Both Saindon and Baneham worked side-by-side with Director James Cameron from

early concept work and motion studies through performance capture, live-action shooting and final delivery. They detail the unique workflow developed for the film and how it varies from traditional VFX pipelines, telling stories along the way.

ACM Reference Format:

Eric Saindon, Joe Letteri, Nicholas Illingworth, Sarah Fitton, Richard Baneham, and Marco Revelant. 2023. Wētā FX Presents Avatar: The Way of Water. In *Proceedings of SIGGRAPH '23 Production Sessions*. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 1 page. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3577023.3585420>

Permission to make digital or hard copies of part or all of this work for personal or classroom use is granted without fee provided that copies are not made or distributed for profit or commercial advantage and that copies bear this notice and the full citation on the first page. Copyrights for third-party components of this work must be honored. For all other uses, contact the owner/author(s).

SIGGRAPH '23 Production Sessions, August 06-10, 2023, Los Angeles, CA, USA

© 2023 Copyright held by the owner/author(s).

ACM ISBN 979-8-4007-0051-4/23/08.

<https://doi.org/10.1145/3577023.3585420>